Deka, her baby and her associates were flown to Guwahati. She was interrogated by the Assam police and Central intelligence officers. During the interrogation, Deka reportedly disclosed valuable information about ULFA and its operations. She also claimed that that Tata Tea was in touch with ULFA. It was the first time that someone close to ULFA's top leadership was making such allegations. This was seized on by the Assam Director General of Police (DGP) K. Hrishikeshan as evidence of the Tatas' alleged links with the terrorist organization.

On 7 September, the DGP held a press conference in Guwahati where he termed the Tata Group as being anti-national. He told the packed hall that Tata Tea had borne all of Deka's medical expenses. He alluded to the documentary evidence the police had in its possession. He accused Tata Tea of paying Deka and her bodyguards' two-way airfare, twice in the same year, as well as her hospital and hotel bills. These arrangements cost lakhs, said the DGP, and gave the break-up of the expenditure incurred.

The police claimed that they had seized letters written by one of Tata Tea's Mumbai-based officers, K. Sridhar, to Jaslok Hospital, requesting a Class A cabin for Deka's use. In the light of the assistance extended for her treatment, DGP Hrishikeshan accused India's largest tea company of waging a war against the state.

The story was splashed across the front pages of the two largest-circulating English newspapers in the country. One headline read, 'Tata Tea is helping ULFA: Assam DGP'. Though in the press conference the DGP targeted the tea companies and primarily Tata Tea, he refrained from releasing to the press damaging evidence that the police had on virtually every organization in the state funding the ULFA. Tata Tea was singled out for the frontal attack, though there was clinching evidence of several big and small tea companies and even state government departments paying the militants.

Nobody could pinpoint the reason for the selective targeting of the Tatas, though most, including eminent lawyer and Rajya Sabha member Ram Jethmalani, were agreed that the opposition to the group was led by the chief minister himself. This only made things more difficult for Ratan as it demanded his larger involvement in the affairs of the tea company. Interaction with the head of a state government could only be done effectively by the group chairman.